

IAS PRELIMS/MAINS

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SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY



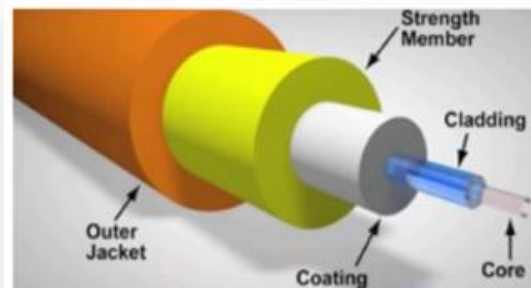
A COMPREHENSIVE COVERAGE

MODULE - 20

INFORMATION & COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY (ICT) - 1

INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY (ICT)

- UNESCO has defined ICT as technology that is used to transmit, process, store, create, display, share or exchange information by electronic means.
- It includes technologies like radio, television, mobile phones, computers, networks, hardware and software, satellite systems, optical fiber networks etc.
- ICT is concerned with storage, retrieval, manipulation, transmission or receipt of digital data.
- So ICT covers any device that will store, retrieve, manipulate, transmit or receive information in digital form.



BENEFITS OF ICT

1 ICT CAN BE A POWERFUL ENABLER OF DEVELOPMENT

Because of its unique characteristics, ICT can significantly improve communication and the exchange of information to strengthen and create new economic and social networks.



2 ICT IS PERVASIVE AND CROSS CUTTING

- ICT can be applied to the full range of human activity from personal use to business and government.
- It is multifunctional and flexible, allowing for tailored solutions based on personalization and localization to meet diverse needs.



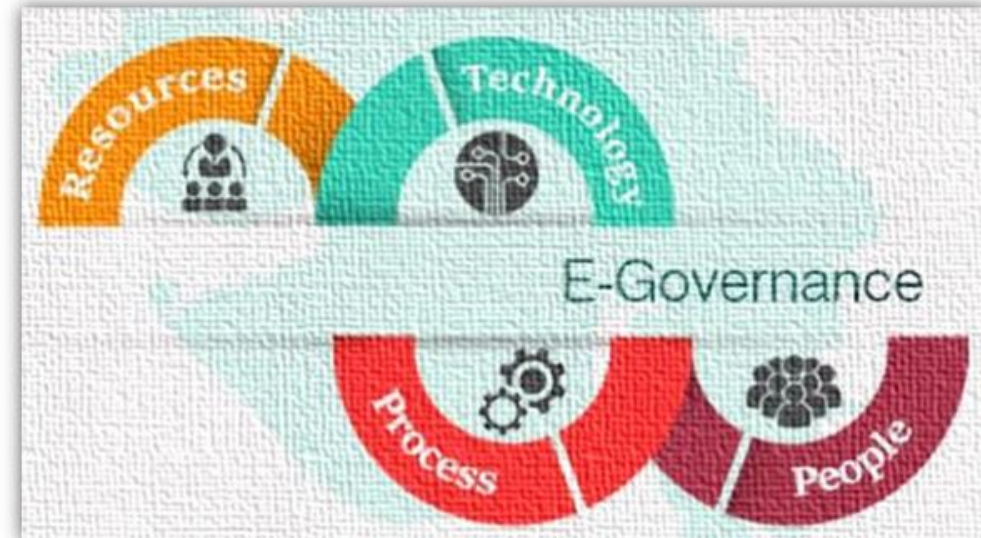
BENEFITS OF ICT

3 ICT FACILITATES DISINTERMEDIATION

ICT makes it possible for users to acquire products and services directly from the original provider, reducing the need for intermediaries. This becomes a considerable source of cost-effectiveness.

4 ICT HAS THE POTENTIAL TO BRING IN MULTIPLE BENEFITS

ICT has the potential to bring in multiple benefits in the areas of governance, integration of marginalized sections, development of rural areas and improvement in major sectors of the economy.



ICT - SOME MAJOR CONCERNS

1 DIGITAL DIVIDE

- It refers to large differences between the sections of population in the distribution and use of ICT resources.
- ✓ Example, internet penetration in urban and rural India is very different.



2 MALWARE

They are programs which are designed to cause damage and loss of data.



ICT - SOME MAJOR CONCERNS

3 HACKING AND PRIVACY ISSUES

- Hackers gain access to others accounts and steal data. Hackers can also break into bank accounts and create financial losses.
- Apart from this, it is possible to track a user's activities in the internet. Such tracking can be misused or be used for marketing purposes.
- There is also the danger of authoritarian governments using ICT to restrict freedom of speech and political activism.



ICT - SOME MAJOR CONCERNS

4 TROLLS AND ABUSERS

- Internet is also the platform for trolling and abusing. Since it is easy to conceal the identity of a user in the internet people resort to these practices more frequently.
- Also, internet can be used for cyber bullying which caused many suicides around the world. There is also the danger of terror organizations using ICT to spread their ideology.



5 HEALTH

Internet and social networking addiction is dangerous and causes many psychological problems.



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